

MODERN ENGLISH

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

(Prescribed Texts)

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: Three Hours

Reading Time: Additional Fifteen Minutes

Instructions to Candidates

1. You are allowed an additional **fifteen minutes** for only reading the question paper.
2. You must **NOT** start writing during reading time.
3. This question paper has 5 printed pages.
4. It has **five** questions in all.
5. Answer **all** questions.
6. While answering Multiple Choice Questions in Section A, you are required to write only **ONE** option as the correct answer.
7. Internal choice has been given in the long answer questions on Drama, Prose and Poetry.
8. Do not exceed the prescribed word limit while answering the questions in Section B.
9. The intended marks for questions are given in brackets [].

Instruction to Supervising Examiner

Kindly read aloud the Instructions given above to all the candidates present in the examination hall.

SECTION A – 20 MARKS

Question 1

Choose the correct options for the following questions.

- (i) At the 'at home' in Act III of the play, *Pygmalion*, what does Eliza tell the guests about her aunt's death? (*Recall*) [1]
- (a) That she died peacefully in her sleep
 - (b) That she was killed in a street accident
 - (c) That she believes the old woman was 'done in'
 - (d) That she died of old age in the workhouse
- (ii) In Acts IV and V of *Pygmalion*, why can Eliza no longer go back to selling flowers? (*Understand*) [1]
- (a) Covent Garden has been closed.
 - (b) Her new speech and manners have unfitted her for her old life.
 - (c) Her father has forbidden it.
 - (d) Higgins has bought her flower basket.

- (iii) Read the two statements about the play, *Pygmalion* and choose the correct option from the ones given below. [1]
- Statement I:** In Act III Mrs Higgins asks what is to be done with Eliza once the experiment is over.
- Statement II:** In Act IV Eliza, alone with Higgins, asks what is to become of her now. (*Understand*)
- Statements I and II are similar.
 - Statement I and II are unrelated to each other.
 - Statement I is the result of Statement II.
 - Statement II is the result of Statement I.
- (iv) In *Pygmalion*, where has Eliza taken refuge by the morning after she leaves Wimpole Street at the end of Act IV? (*Recall*) [1]
- At her father's lodgings
 - Back at Covent Garden
 - At the Eynsford Hills' home
 - At Mrs Higgins's house
- (v) In the short story, *The Doll's House*, how does Aunt Beryl drive the Kelveys out of the courtyard? (*Recall*) [1]
- She calls their mother.
 - She shoos them away like chickens.
 - She sets the dog on them.
 - She locks the gate.
- (vi) In the short story, *The Father-Thing*, how do the boys finally kill the creature? (*Recall*) [1]
- By pouring kerosene down its tunnel
 - By crushing it under the concrete slab
 - By calling the police
 - By trapping it in the trash barrel
- (vii) In the short story, *The Dreamer*, what is Cyprian doing when his aunt finds him in the book department? (*Recall*) [1]
- Reading poetry in a corner
 - Looking for his lost hat
 - Selling two devotional books to an elderly Canon
 - Buying a present for his aunt
- (viii) In the poem, *Urban*, what has happened to the river in the man's world? (*Recall*) [1]
- It has flooded the city.
 - It has been polluted by factories.
 - It has been diverted into a canal.
 - It is dry.

- (ix) Which of the following animals is NOT mentioned in the poem, *Refugee Blues*? (Recall) [1]
- (a) A poodle
 - (b) A cat
 - (c) Fish
 - (d) A horse
- (x) In the poem, *Ode to Tomatoes*, why does the poet say that the tomato is so generous? (Understand) [1]
- (a) It grows without water.
 - (b) It has no pit, husk, leaves or thorns, so nothing is wasted.
 - (c) It is cheap in the market.
 - (d) It can be stored all winter.

Question 2

Answer any **five** of the following subparts in 40-50 words.

- (i) In Act V of *Pygmalion*, why does Doolittle blame Higgins for his new prosperity? (Understand) [2]
- (ii) In Act V of *Pygmalion*, why is Mrs Higgins angry that Higgins and Pickering have gone to the police? (Understand) [2]
- (iii) In the short story, *The Doll's House*, why does the teacher have a 'special voice' for the Kelveys? (Interpret) [2]
- (iv) In the short story, *The Father-Thing*, why does Mrs Walton not believe Charles? (Understand) [2]
- (v) In the poem, *Urban*, what does the man's dream of morning walks alone suggest? (Interpret) [2]
- (vi) In the poem, *My Grandmother's House*, why was the speaker proud when she lived in the house? (Recall) [2]

SECTION B – 60 MARKS

PYGMALION: GEORGE BERNARD SHAW

Question 3

- (i) What part does Freddy Eynsford Hill play in Acts III to V of *Pygmalion*? What does Eliza see in him? [5]
- Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words. (Understand)
- His reaction at the 'at home'
 - His devotion in Act IV and what it offers Eliza
- (ii) Describe Mrs Higgins's role in Acts III and V of *Pygmalion*. Why is she important to the play? [5]
- Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words. (Interpret)
- Her warning in Act III
 - Her handling of Higgins and Eliza in Act V

- (iii) **(a)** Higgins claims that he treats a duchess and a flower girl alike. Is this a fair defence of his conduct towards Eliza? Give your opinion with reference to Acts III to V. [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Evaluate*)

OR

- (b)** Why, in your opinion, does Eliza decide to marry Freddy rather than return to Wimpole Street with Higgins? [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Evaluate*)

PERSPECTIVES: A COLLECTION OF SHORT STORIES

Question 4

- (i) Referring to the short story, *Death by Scrabble*, describe the words that appear on the board and what seems to follow from them. [5]

Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.

(*Interpret*)

- The words played
- Their apparent consequences

- (ii) In the short story, *The Father-Thing*, what do the boys find in the garden, and how is it linked to the father-thing? [5]

Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.

(*Understand*)

- The creature and its burrow
- Its link to the father-thing and the pods

- (iii) **(a)** How does Cyprian turn his aunt's shopping expedition to his own advantage in the short story, *The Dreamer*? Discuss the irony and the comic reversal in the story. [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Analyse*)

OR

- (b)** Comment on the significance of the title of the short story, *Games at Twilight*. [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Evaluate*)

REFLECTIONS: A COLLECTION OF POEMS

Question 5

- (i) In the poem, *The Black Santa*, what does the child ask for, and what does the wish-list reveal about the child's world? [5]

Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.

(*Interpret*)

- The child's list and where the ideas come from
- What it shows about the setting and society

- (ii) In the poem, *My Grandmother's House*, what does the speaker long for, and how does she imagine having it again? [5]

Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.
(Understand)

- What she misses
- How she means to have it

- (iii) (a) In the poem, *Ode to Tomatoes*, how does the 'murder' of the tomato become a 'wedding'? [10]
How does the form of the poem suit its celebration of a humble thing?

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (Analyse)

OR

- (b) How does Auden use refrain, repetition and contrast in the poem, *Refugee Blues*, to convey the suffering of the refugees? [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (Analyse)

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